

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 875

By Haile

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Donald Kenton Wright of Sumner County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Donald Kenton Wright; and

WHEREAS, Don Wright was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Louisville, Kentucky, on September 22, 1939, Don Wright was the son of Joe Willie Wright and Hallie Marie House Wright; he graduated from Goodlettsville High School in 1958; and

WHEREAS, he went on to serve in the United States Army as a military policeman at the Raven Rock Mountain Complex, a secure underground nuclear bunker in Pennsylvania known as "The Little Pentagon," an experience that shaped his strong character and dedication to his duties as a citizen; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wright's professional journey included a fulfilling career as a pipefitter and an educator, teaching drafting at a trade school in Lebanon; his commitment to public service was evident during his tenure as a Tennessee State Senator from 1992 to 1996 and as the mayor of Gallatin from 1997 to 2006. Through his leadership, he made a lasting impact on his community; and

WHEREAS, he was also an accomplished author, leaving behind a literary legacy that includes titles such as *The Woodsman*, *The Captive*, *The Last Plantation*, and *Gone to Texas*, works that reflect his creativity and passion for history and storytelling; and

WHEREAS, Don Wright enjoyed attending church and was a longtime member of First Baptist Church of Gallatin; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wright was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his wife of thirty years, Patricia Wright; his brother, David (Jane) Wright; his grandson, James Kenton Wright; his two great-grandchildren; his brothers-in-law, Ralph Gregory and Steve (Gayla) Gregory; his sisters-in-law, Peggy (Larry) Ard and Judy (Harry) Mann; and numerous nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his daughter, Candace Elizabeth Wright; brother, Joseph Maxwell Wright; and sister-in-law, Elizabeth Ann Gregory; and

WHEREAS, Don Wright's indelible spirit and positivity shone brightly throughout his life, earning him a reputation as someone who was friendly and never met a stranger; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Donald Kenton Wright, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Wright.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.